confirmed by Naik and Nurullah in their seminal work on Indian education, the following positions of the Evangelical school were accepted:

> 1. Only partial and imperfect results could be expected from the attempts to teach European science through the medium of Sanskrit or Arabic;
> 2. The principal aim of educational policy should be to communicate, through the English language, a complete education in European literature, philosophy, and science to the greatest number of students who may be found ready to accept it; and
> 3. Attempts of the government should be restricted to the extension of higher education to the upper classes of society who have leisure for study and whose culture would filter down to the masses.

Clearly, while increasing the allocation of funds to the Orientalist cause, the emphasis still remained on advancing the cause of English education and the spread of English ideas, apart from adopting a conscious policy of co-opting the Indian upper classes into higher education in the hope that the rest of the Indian society would aspire to follow their lead. This, according to scholars, such as Naik and Nurullah, was the Downward Filtration Theory in official action, which would characterise British education policy in Bharat at least until 1870.

The long and short of the preceding discussion on religion, caste, tribe and education, based on primary sources as well as scholarly literature, is that at least until 1853, the intention of the Christian European coloniser was to establish a politico-legal and social infrastructure which aided the spread of Christian colonial consciousness in every aspect of the native society. Therefore, in contemporary conversations and debates which touch upon religion, caste/tribe, education or any other aspect for that matter, the first step should be to check for the influence of colonial assumptions and colonial consciousness before proceeding to pass judgements on the past or evaluating contemporary practices and structures for relevance. Until and unless this exercise is undertaken, it must be presumed that our conversations happen within the Christian colonial framework *and* based on Christian colonialised versions of native OET.

Also, sometimes members of the indigenous society take pride and comfort in the fact that despite the best efforts of the Christian European coloniser, Bharat has remained un-proselytised for the most part. While I